

TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON CONSERVATION COMMISSION

MEETING Minutes

For the Westhampton Conservation Commission meeting on May 20, 2026 at 7:00 P.M. in their office at the Westhampton Town Hall, #1 South Road Westhampton

Members Present: Fred, Bill, Alyson, Jessica (recording)

Also in attendance: Barry Searle, (RS), Kate Bednaz (soil scientist), Risa Teall, David Della Torre, John Della Torre, Janice Pegels, Jim Jewell

1.Call to Order: 7:04 pm

2. Accept Minutes meeting of: May 6, 2026

3. Review Correspondence:

Richard Olivo, 84 Easthampton Rd., re: repair to stone embankment and regrade small lawn area bordering stream adjacent to their property (scheduled for June 3);

Angela Panaccione (PVPC), re: reschedule BNOI presentation and continuation of NOI for slip-line work under Reservoir Rd. on behalf of Town of Westhampton Highway Department; (rescheduled for July 1)

Kate Bednaz, soil scientist, on behalf of 70 PIL, re: NOI hearing and site visit;

Tommy Stang, re: Westhampton Town Forest;

Doug Finn, re: signatures for "Project Agreements";

Phil Dowling, re: RDA for removing and replacing old garage on Hathaway Rd. property;

4. Old/Ongoing Business: signatures for two "Project Agreements" (previously signed in October), includes minor changes to funding structure, signed by Selectboard;
Cons Com votes to sign

5. New Business: NOI hearing, 70 PIL—Richard Searle (RS—design for septic), Kate Bednaz, soil/wetlands scientist, Freshwater Wetland Services, on behalf of property owners, Risa Teall, David Della Torre, John Della Torre

Close Meeting: 7:12

Open Hearing: 7:13

Proposed septic tank (BOH approval pending); neighboring properties with wells nearby take precedence; septic tank size will be reduced; less flow; bottomless sand filter; electric pump; septic systems out of Cons Com jurisdiction, waiting on approval from BOH; 25 ft. from lake;

Will result in improved septic system, better for ecology; while work is being done, property owners want to improve property;; deck will be moved slightly; invasive species removed; native species/plantings, such as highbush blueberry, will be planted, lawn area improved; will remove railroad tie steps; parking area with retaining wall; erosion controls installed to catch roadway runoff; a few trees have been/will need to be removed, but most large trees remain to help keep soil in place, etc.; function and usability will be improved; septic repaired; looks like a good system, but what about maintenance/upkeep?

Question about safe distance between lake and septic tank; is there standard acceptable distance?—no option; Concerns about services available for continued/annual maintenance and monitoring of septic system;

Solid plans; Cons Com votes to approve plans for 70 PIL;
Cons Com will issue and deliver OOC after approval of septic by BOH, which should be soon;
Cons Com will be notified about meeting with BOH;

Hearing Continued: 7:45pm (will schedule continuance after BOH meeting);

Resume Meeting: 7:47pm

New Business Continued:

Concerns about mowing on Duck Island; Jess Applin will survey property to make determinations and advise; near CR property; HLT, Cons Com, and Laurie Sanders may have suggestions about preservation of native species growing on the island;

Jess Applin (HLT): Mass Mapper Presentation: 7:55

Phil Dowling, Hathaway Rd.: schedule **site visit**

Alyson: swimming area with rocks? Check site

6. Agenda next mtg to Town Clerk's mailbox: Agenda/Notice will be sent to Town Clerk for June 3, 2026

7. Adjourn: 8:55